

KAYLANI RIVERA

krivera28.github.io | kaykayr2882@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/kaylani-rivera | [773-240-2402](tel:773-240-2402)

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Expected May 2027

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science with a Minor in Game Studies & Design

GPA: 3.8/4.0

- Relevant coursework: Web Programming, Interactive Computer Graphics, Game Development, Data Structures, Systems Programming, Algorithms & Models of Computation, Computer Architecture, Programming Languages & Compilers
- Honors: Dean's List, James Scholar, President's Award Program Scholarship, State Farm Computer Science Scholarship
- Campus Involvement: ACM@UIUC (Infrastructure Chair & Social Lead), HackIllinois (Co-Director), BUILT by Colorstack (Social Director), Adventure Club (Membership Director), Women in Computer Science (social team)

WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

August 2026 – Present

Course Assistant, CS 415: Game Development

Urbana, IL

- Support **hundreds of students** developing games in Unreal Engine by hosting office hours and troubleshooting technical, gameplay, and design challenges
- Evaluate student projects and provide actionable feedback on technical implementation, gameplay functionality, and design
- Develop exam questions and collaborate with other course staff to identify student learning gaps, address recurring development challenges, and align grading standards

Goldman Sachs

June 2026 – August 2026

Summer Analyst – Controllers Software Engineering Intern

New York, NY

- Implemented a Kafka-based producer-consumer pipeline in Java to consolidate **hundreds** of financial exception calculations into a few batch operations, reducing alert volume **from hundreds to single digits** during downstream service outages
- Automated the quarterly regulatory fund scoping process with AI to identify in-scope investment funds across multiple data sources and consolidate separate manual processes into a single workflow, increasing reporting efficiency and accuracy
- Coordinated Kafka provisioning and security approvals with cross-functional teams to unblock critical CI/CD deployments

Girls Who Code

June 2025 – Aug 2025 & May 2024 – Aug 2024

Lead Teaching Assistant

Remote

- Taught interactive daily lessons in JavaScript's p5.js library on programming fundamentals and game development principles to **300+** high school students, evolving the curriculum to match student needs and achieving **94%** project completion
- Mentored students through check-ins, feedback, and collaborative sessions to improve retention, confidence, and engagement

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) @ UIUC

September 2024 – January 2026

Infrastructure Chair

Urbana, IL

- Directed the development of ACM's internal management platform using React, TypeScript, and AWS Lambda, improving reliability to **99.9%** uptime and delivering internal resources to **1,000+** members
- Led UX redesign initiatives by gathering member feedback, identifying usability improvements, and collaborating with developers to improve discoverability, increasing resource engagement by **26%** and active membership by **14%**
- Established Agile/Scrum and CI/CD processes across seven teams, improving coordination and streamlining release cycles

HackIllinois

October 2023 – September 2024

Co-Director

Urbana, IL

- Led **50+** staff members in planning and executing the Midwest's largest student-run hackathon, serving **800+** participants
- Established weekly roadmap reviews and cross-team meetings to improve alignment and accelerate milestone completion
- Coordinated event budget, logistics, and execution with corporate partners, leading to a **53%** increase in sponsorship prizes

PROJECTS

Gamify – Frontend Developer & PM

Java, HTML, CSS, TypeScript, Node.js, and Vue.js

- Designed and developed a productivity web app that gamifies daily task management, encouraging long-term engagement
- Created a dynamic progress tracking system that visualizes user achievements through real-time data updates and rewards
- Managed project milestones, task delegation, and feature integration to deliver a cohesive user experience

Recipe Sorter – Fullstack Developer

HTML, CSS, and JavaScript

- Built a data-driven recipe management platform to simplify organization and discovery through real-time search and filtering
- Implemented dynamic filtering and sorting features based on user feedback to improve usability and personalization
- Automated data synchronization using Google Apps Script, eliminating manual updates and reducing maintenance overhead

SKILLS

Programming Languages & Libraries: C/C++, Java, Python, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, p5.js, Numpy, Pandas, SciPy

Tools: Git/GitHub, Jira, Confluence, VS Code, IntelliJ, Docker, Notion, Canva, Figma, Unreal Engine, Unity, Devin, Excel, LaTeX

Technical Interests: Product Management, Project Management, Frontend Development, UI/UX Design, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), Game Development, Website Development, Software Engineering